

Rizq Khairulnizam

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EDUCATION

The Pennsylvania State University | Majlis Amanah Rakyat (MARA) YTP Scholar

Cybersecurity Analytics and Operations, B.S.

Security and Risk Analysis, Minor

Information Sciences and Technology, Minor

National Security Agency, Certificate

University Park, USA

Graduated: May 2026

CGPA: 3.90/4.00

Honors: Cum Laude

Dean's List: 8/8 Semesters

PROFESSIONAL CERTIFICATION

CompTIA Network+ (N10-009)

June 2026

ISC2 Certified in Cybersecurity (CC)

July 2024

WORK EXPERIENCE

The Pennsylvania State University, College of Information Sciences and Technology

Learning Assistant for SRA365 (R) and SRA211 (Terrorism and Crime)

Learning Assistant for IST210 (MySQL) and SRA231 (Decision Theory and Analysis)

University Park, USA

January 2026 – May 2026

August 2024 – December 2025

CyberSecurity Malaysia, MyCERT

Security Analyst Intern

Cyberjaya, Malaysia

June 2025 – August 2025

- Competed in the international Standoff Cyberbattle for SPIEF 2025 as part of “Pasukan Biru,” representing Malaysia against international teams, ranked 4th out of 12, and resolved 1/7 cases by performing a complete kill chain and an incident investigation.
- Gained hands-on experience with physical penetration testing tools and configured a custom attack device for wireless exploitation.
- Developed 3 Red Team documentation including Rules of Engagement (RoE), Letter of Authorization (LoA), and legal guidelines.
- Developed and delivered comprehensive training sessions to department staff on 11 red team exercise types, social engineering tactics, and non-verbal communication cues to strengthen security awareness, espionage prevention, and insider threat detection.

Nexagate, Managed Security Department

Managed Security Intern

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

May 2024 – August 2024

- Developed a dashboard that visualizes user account movement across networks using Sankey diagrams to track lateral movements.
- Conducted Incident Response (IR) using Splunk SIEM to triage alerts, reduce false positives, and notify affected clients.
- Analyzed threat reports, mapped TTPs to MITRE ATT&CK and extracted IoCs to produce weekly client-facing threat intelligence.
- Monitored logs and produced weekly reports on the traffic status and condition of 5 client domains with Imperva WAF.

PROJECT EXPERIENCE

JURUS Secure Healthcare System Deployment

Individual

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

May 2026 – July 2026

- Designed and deployed a secure healthcare system on AWS EC2 Ubuntu instance using Docker, OpenEMR, MariaDB, and Nginx.
- Hardened the infrastructure with HTTPS/TLS, SSH conf, UFW, Fail2Ban, security headers, and least-privilege database access.
- Secured OpenEMR with MFA, RBAC and implemented centralized monitoring using Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, and Promtail.
- Automated database and docker compose backups using Bash, Cron, AWS S3 and presented complete architecture to 2 panelists.

Abnormal Traffic Dashboard on Splunk SIEM

Team Member

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

June 2024 – August 2024

- Designed and developed an analytical Splunk dashboard aimed to assist 10 SOC Security Analysts in monitoring activity, recording abnormally high or low log count, and calculating future projections of 5 firewall hosts.
- Scripted 3 complex SPL queries to gain targeted graphs and visuals of traffic deviations using the standard deviation of the dataset.
- Scripted 2 complex SPL queries to track the all-time-high record for 1 firewall host and export the record into a lookup table.

SKILLS

Technical: Linux, Bash, R, SQL (MySQL and MariaDB), Splunk SPL, Cron, AWS (EC2, S3, IAM, Security Groups), Docker, Nginx

Offensive: Red Team Operations Planning, Social Engineering, Offensive Security Governance, Wireless Penetration Testing

Defensive: Malware Analysis, Threat Intelligence, Security Hardening, Network Security, Incident Response, Business Continuity

Security Tools: Splunk SIEM, Elastic SIEM, Imperva WAF, OpenCTI, UFW, Fail2Ban, Grafana, Prometheus, Loki, Promtail

Languages: Malay (Native), English (Bilingual), Japanese (N5)

HONORS & AWARDS

JURUS Level 1 – ANALYST (Ranked 4th / 30)

RawSEC & Cybersecurity Research Centre (CYRES), Universiti Sains Malaysia (USM)

Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia

June 2026

- Awarded the ANALYST badge and certificate after passing a comprehensive six-domain cybersecurity engineering assessment.

Certificate of Academic Excellence

Majlis Amanah Rakyat (MARA)

University Park, USA

December 2025

- Awarded a Certificate of Academic Excellence for maintaining a CGPA above 3.50 and achieving a 4.00 GPA in Spring 2025.